THREE

The Second Indo-Pakistani War

The UN cease-fire line in Kashmir could not prevent heavy artillery from firing over it or Pakistani infiltrators from crossing it. Nor were there ever enough UN monitors to do more than report violations of the cease-fire they were employed to enforce. The United Nations had no army of its own, after all, nor money enough to keep more than a few monitors posted at distant stations along that porous line.

Pakistan's chief of army staff in 1957, General Muhammad Ayub Khan, was furious when India announced that the adoption of Jammu and Kashmir's new constitution made that state an integral part of the Indian Union. Colonel Ayub, a graduate of Britain's Royal Military College at Sandhurst, had been in command of Punjab's small partition-border force, which he kept in barracks in 1947, failing to stop any of the murders of Hindus and Sikhs fleeing Lahore. After Pakistan joined SEATO, Ayub flew to Georgia in the United States for special forces training, and also visited Texas and Langley, Virginia, headquarters of the CIA, returning to Pakistan as its top general. Ayub was a good soldier, but during his sojourn in the United States he had acquired political ambitions, and upon returning home he soon lost patience with what he called the "idiocy" of Pakistan's civil leaders and consensus-seeking politicians. Ayub had no trouble convincing President General Iskandar Mirza, a Parsi, of his views about the ineptitude of Pakistan's politicians, especially voluble Bengalis like Prime Minister H. S. Suhrawardy, whose tenure had lasted only a year when he was forced to resign by a vote of no confidence in October 1957. A year later, Mirza abrogated Pakistan's constitution and appointed Ayub Khan chief martial law administrator.